



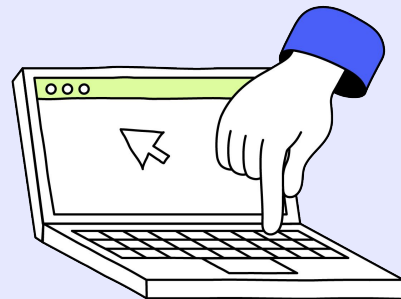
Module 8:

Capstone Preparation



In the chat, share:

- One thing you're excited about for the Capstone
- One thing that makes you nervous





Agenda

- Introduction to the Capstone
- Developing the project proposal
- Written report overview
- KSB breakdown
- Oral presentation overview
- Presentation skeleton



Introduction to the Capstone



What makes up the EPA

AM1

Project report with
presentation (aka
Capstone Project or
Work-Based Project)

50%

AM2

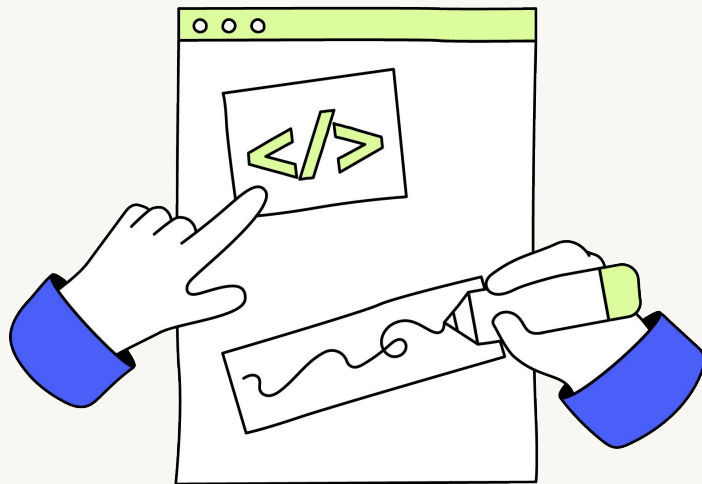
Professional
discussion with
portfolio

50%

AM1 component 1: Written report

Purpose: Provide a substantial piece of work that demonstrates your ability to apply your learning to real-world challenges

Length: 6,000 words (+/- 10%)

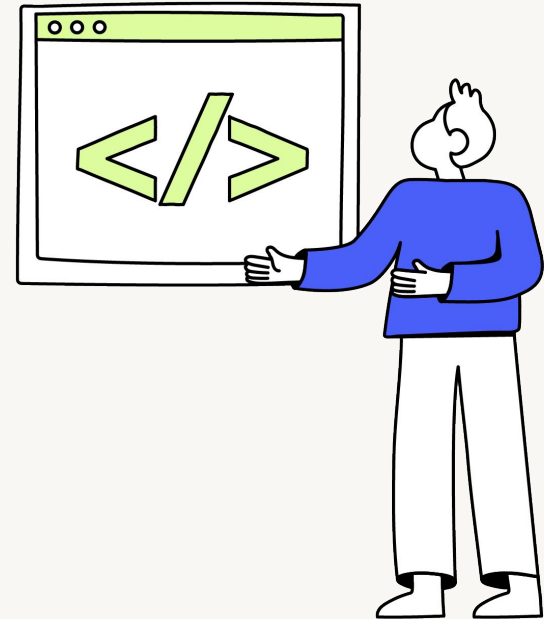




AM1 component 2: Presentation with questioning

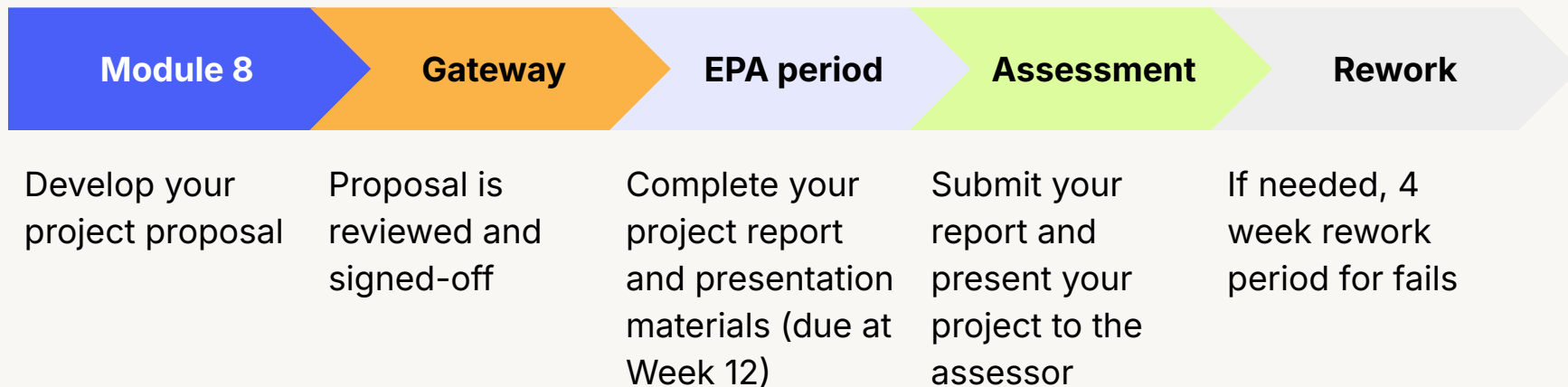
Purpose: Assess your ability to articulate your learning and project experiences, demonstrating the application of knowledge and skills evidenced in the Capstone Project

Structure: 30 minute presentation, 30 minute Q&A with assessor (up to 10% buffer)





AM1 timeline



Note: You may not work on your report or presentation until you pass Gateway



Choosing a project topic

The project is a substantial and clearly-defined piece of work that delivers real business value.

It should be meaningful, measurable, and aligned with your professional development and your organisation's objectives.

It should also allow you to obtain evidence for each of the AM1 KSBs.

A good project is...

- **Relevant** to your job role and responsibilities
- **Achievable** within the timeframe and resources available
- **Significant enough** to demonstrate your knowledge, skills, and behaviours at the appropriate level



Q&A checkpoint





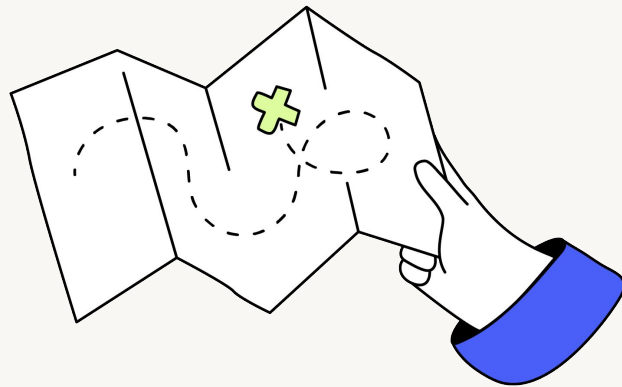
Developing the project proposal



Project proposal

Purpose: Demonstrate that your project has the scope and focus to meet all AM1 KSBs

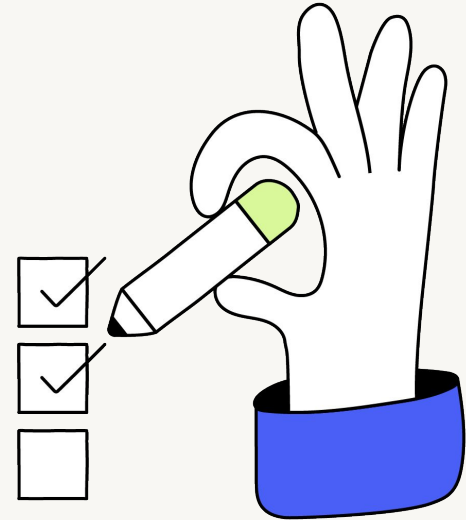
Content: Project title and summary, timeframes, and contact information





Project proposal logistics

- Submitted to EPAO for sign-off (not formal assessment)
- Signed off within 2 weeks after submission
- Once the proposal is signed-off, you may pass Gateway and enter the EPA period**





Project proposal components

Apprentice details	
Name	
Preferred pronouns	
Email	
Start date	
Timeframes	
Dates unavailable	
Reasonable adjustments	
Target submission date	



Project proposal components

Project details	
Project title	Simple, descriptive title
Project summary	Describe the project scope Explain business impact Include high-level implementation plan Tag KSBs <i>Typically 500 words</i>
Stakeholder specification	Outline the specification: user stories, functional and non-functional requirements, etc.
Research needs	Research needed to support your project



Access the template

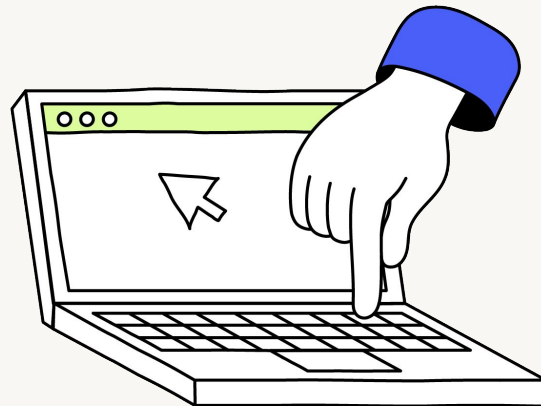
Open My Multiverse: ASWE Capstone Project (AM1) Readiness Tool module



Navigate to the "Developing a Project Proposal" page



Review the guidelines and download the project proposal template





1

Understand the project base

A successful project should address the needs of a customer or stakeholder by focusing on one of the following:

- **A specific problem** – A known issue or gap that needs resolving.
- **A recurring issue** – A persistent challenge requiring a long-term solution.
- **An idea or opportunity** – A new feature or innovation that adds value or addresses emerging needs.



2

Identify and propose a suitable project base

1. Engage with stakeholders

Hold meetings or use surveys to gather insights and identify needs or issues.

2. Analyse feedback

Categorise feedback into problems, recurring issues, and opportunities.

Prioritise based on impact, feasibility, and relevance to your skill set.

3. Conduct preliminary research

Explore existing solutions and relevant technologies or tools.

4. Draft a preliminary proposal

Clearly define the problem, proposed solution, tools, and estimated resources.



3

Validate your proposal

- **Peer review** – Get feedback from colleagues or mentors to refine your proposal.
- **Feasibility check** – Ensure your idea is realistic within the given constraints.
- **Stakeholder review** – Share the draft with stakeholders and adjust based on input.
- **KSB alignment** – Make sure the proposal supports the required knowledge, skills, and behaviours (KSBs).



4

Finalise the proposal

- **Incorporate feedback** – Update your draft to reflect stakeholder and peer input.
- **Implementation plan** – Outline clear steps, timelines, and deliverables.
- **Risk assessment** – Identify potential risks and how you plan to manage them.



Q&A checkpoint





Written report overview



Project report sections

Introduction	Overview and context of the project
Project scope	Objectives, key performance indicators, and stakeholder engagement
Project plan	Timelines, tasks, and responsibilities
Analysis and problem solving	Problems faced and methods used to address them
Research and findings	Evidence-based insights that informed your decisions
Project outcomes	Results and outputs delivered through your project
Recommendations and conclusions	Key takeaways, lessons learned, and suggested next steps



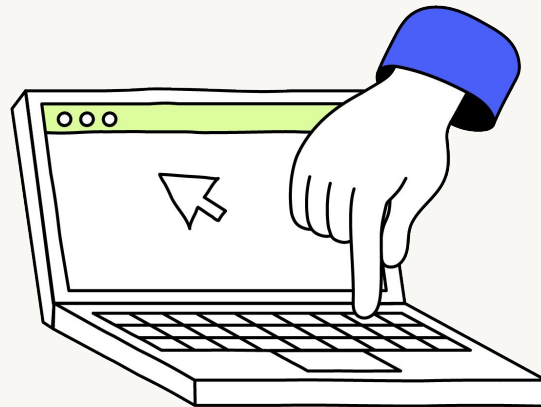
Access report guidelines

Open My Multiverse: ASWE Capstone
Project (AM1) Readiness Tool module



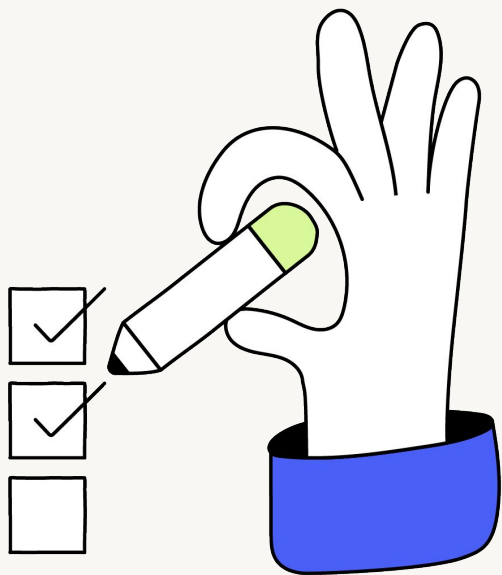
Review the information provided in the
following resources:

"Structuring Your Project" page
"Project Contents" section
"Appendix" section





Submission requirements

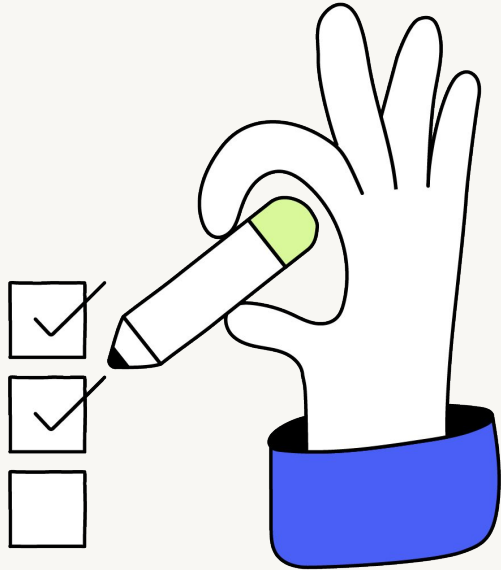


Word count

- 6,000 words total, +/- 10%
- Appendices, diagrams, and references do not count towards total word count
- Submissions above 10% margin will be cut off
- Include word count table in your report



Submission requirements

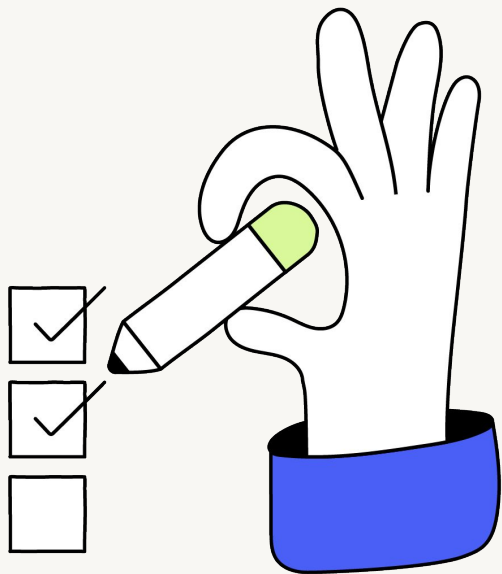


References

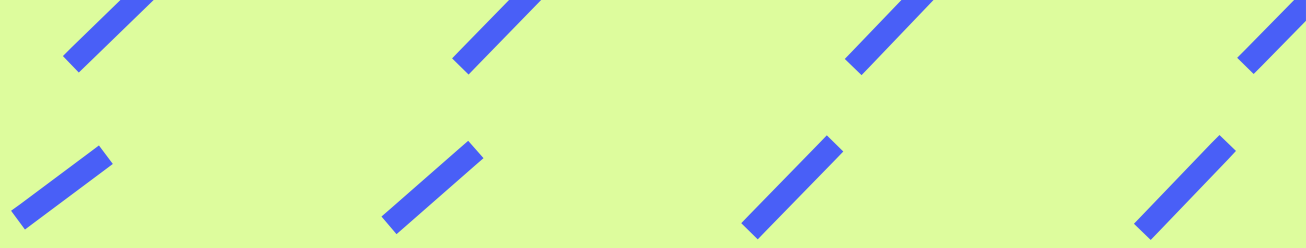
- Use a consistent referencing style throughout (Harvard Referencing Style is recommended)
- Reference list goes in your report, before Appendices



Submission requirements



- **Cover page:** Project title and submission details only
- **Appendices:** Information that supports, the main report
 - Data tables, charts, templates, full analyses
 - KSB mapping
 - Declaration
- **Anonymisation:** Personal identifiers removed



You may collaborate with a team to deliver your project, but your **project report must be your own original work.**

It should clearly reflect your individual role and contribution.



Q&A checkpoint





Complete the self-assessment

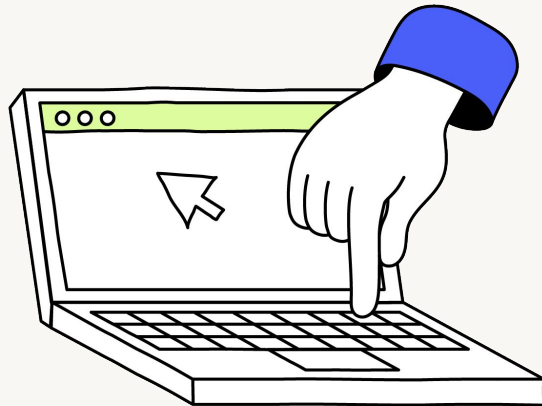
Open My Multiverse: ASWE Capstone
Project (AM1) Readiness Tool module



Navigate to the “EPA Self-Assessment” page



Complete the quiz to check your
understanding of key EPA concepts



EPA self-assessment debrief

1. What areas of the EPA and AM1 are you most confident in?
2. What areas do you need to review?





Independent work time



Independent work time

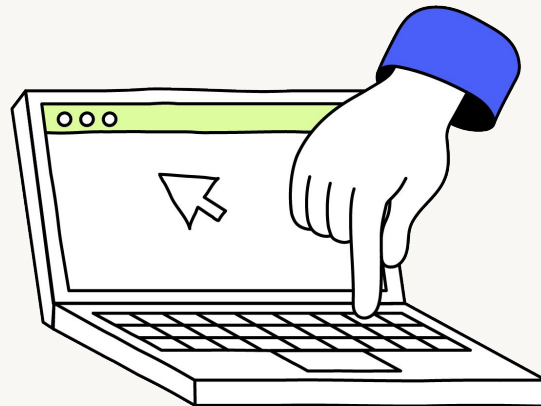
Open My Multiverse: ASWE Capstone Project (AM1) Readiness Tool module



Review the project proposal resources



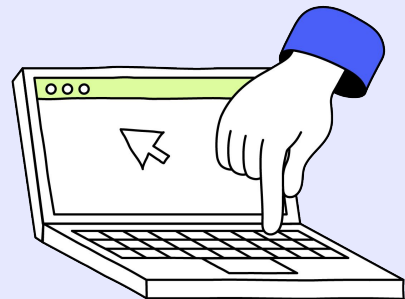
Begin working on your Capstone project and proposal independently





What steps did you take to start your Capstone?

What do you need to do next?





Next steps

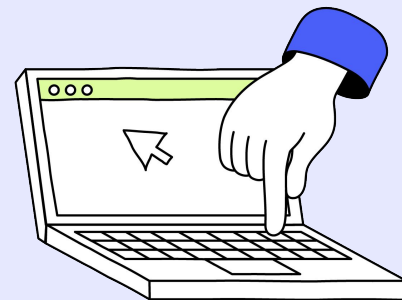
- Work on your project proposal
- Log your OTJ



Welcome back!



In the chat, share one insight or "ah ha" moment about the Capstone you gained in the last workshop.





Agenda

- Introduction to the Capstone
- Developing the project proposal
- Written report overview
- KSB breakdown
- Oral presentation overview
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KSB breakdown



AM1 KSBs

Knowledge	
K1	K18
K2	K25
K3	K26
K4	K27
K5	
K15	
K17	

Skills	
S1	S16
S2	S17
S3	S18
S5	S19
S6	S22
S13	S26
S14	

Behaviours
B3
B5



Phase 1: Define the Problem and Plan the Solution

Focus: Understanding the business context, analysing the problem, proposing solutions, scoping, and planning the delivery using project management methods.

1. Introduce the organisation, department, and role

KSBs

Contextual introduction – no specific KSBs

Tips

- Describe your company's mission or digital focus.
- Explain your role and responsibilities within the team.



Phase 1: Define the Problem and Plan the Solution

Focus: Understanding the business context, analysing the problem, proposing solutions, scoping, and planning the delivery using project management methods.

2. Describe the situation and identify the problem

KSBs	S1, S3
Tips	● Explain how the issue was discovered. ● Use a Fishbone diagram or 5 Whys for root cause analysis. ● Clearly state the problem statement at the end.

3. Research and investigate potential solutions

KSBs	K18, S14, K1
Tips	● Identify at least two potential solutions. ● Research similar approaches used in industry. ● Consider costs, technical fit, long-term alignment.



Phase 1: Define the Problem and Plan the Solution

Focus: Understanding the business context, analysing the problem, proposing solutions, scoping, and planning the delivery using project management methods.

4. Critically evaluate alternatives and choose a solution

KSBs	K2
Tips	• Compare the alternatives using a decision matrix or gap analysis • Show why the chosen solution is best aligned to business strategy and needs

5. Pitch the solution and write a goal statement

KSBs	K4
Tips	• Present a clear goal statement • Link it to business value (e.g., improve efficiency by 30%)



Phase 1: Define the Problem and Plan the Solution

Focus: Understanding the business context, analysing the problem, proposing solutions, scoping, and planning the delivery using project management methods.

6. Define the project scope

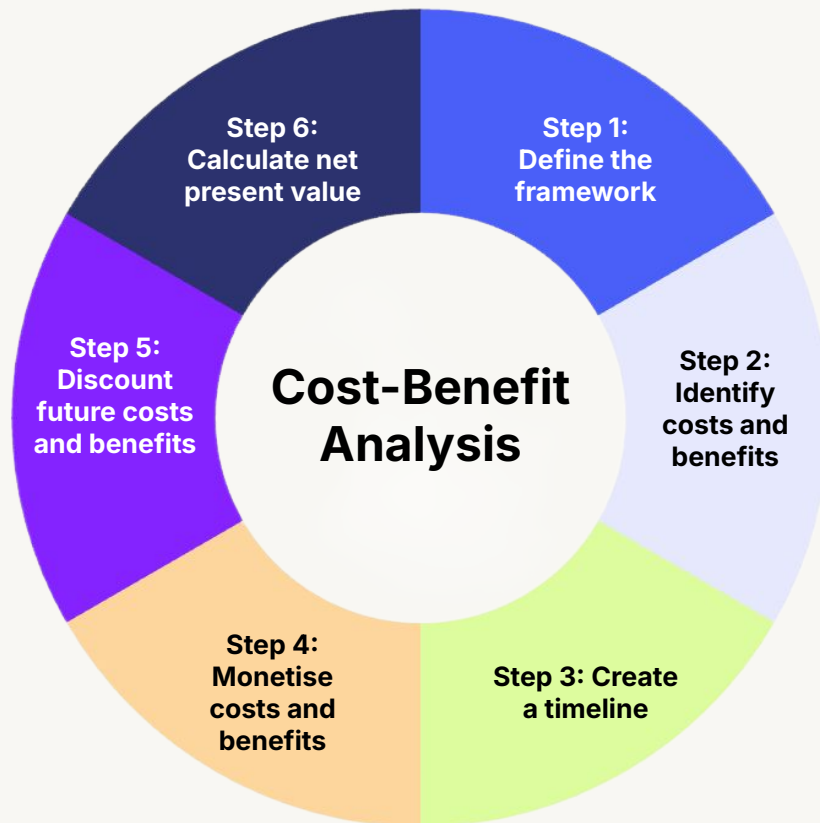
KSBs	K4
Tips	• Use a scope diagram or tool like MoSCoW • List what's in and out of scope explicitly • Conduct an impact analysis

7. List project deliverables and objectives

KSBs	K4
Tips	• Present the goal using the SMART framework • Break goal into specific deliverables (e.g., software component, test plan, documentation, etc.)



Impact analysis techniques





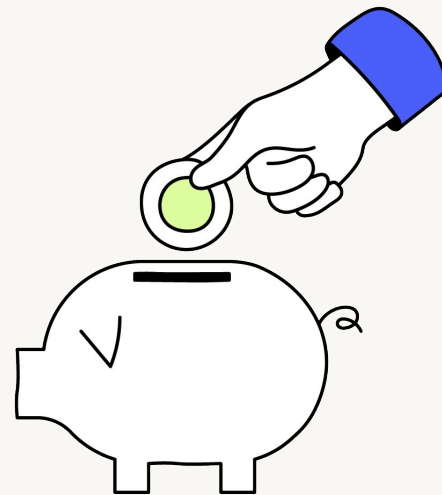
Impact analysis techniques

Business Impact Analysis

Link your analysis to real-world outcomes by focussing on how the solution affects critical operations, like improvements in service delivery, customer satisfaction, compliance, or internal efficiency.

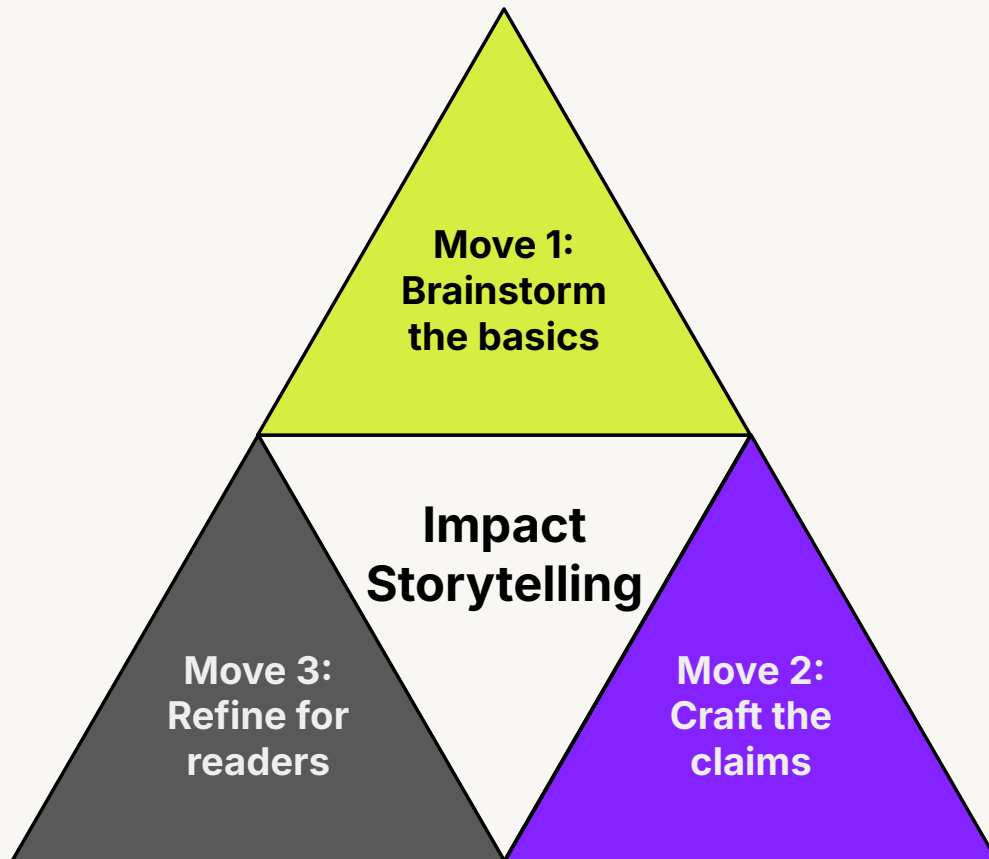
For example:

- Did your pipeline reduce lead time for changes?
- Did your refactoring effort improve latency?
- How does this align with business strategy or KPIs?





Impact analysis techniques





Phase 1: Define the Problem and Plan the Solution

Focus: Understanding the business context, analysing the problem, proposing solutions, scoping, and planning the delivery using project management methods.

8. Choose and apply a project management methodology

KSBs

S5

Tips

- Choose from Agile, Waterfall, ISO, or Hybrid
- Explain why the method suits this project
- Apply it clearly in your planning

9. Estimate time, cost, and constraints

KSBs

K15

Tips

- Use cost estimation models or time-boxing (budget analysis)
- Show how your estimates support realistic delivery (timelines)
- Use PM tools (Gantt Charts, Kanban)



Phase 1: Define the Problem and Plan the Solution

Focus: Understanding the business context, analysing the problem, proposing solutions, scoping, and planning the delivery using project management methods.

10. Perform risk assessment and mitigation planning

KSBs

K3, S2

Tips

- Create a risk register with likelihood, impact, and mitigation
- Include mitigation cost in the budget analysis
- Full risk assessment

11. Plan stakeholder analysis

KSBs

K17, S13

Tips

- Do a stakeholder analysis:
 - Identification
 - Categorisation
 - RACI matrix



Full risk assessment

1. Risk identification
2. Initial risk register
3. Response strategy
4. Interdependencies
5. Mitigation strategies
6. Calculate costs associated with risk
7. Revise risk register (submit this one)
8. Add costs to budget analysis
9. Risk owners
10. Explain how you are going to monitor risks

Sr No	Date Raised	Risk Description	Likelihood of the risk	Impact of the risk occurs	Severity	Owner	Mitigating Action	Contingency Plan	Progress on Action	Status	Resource
1	20 Dec 2021	Project Sprints stories are not well defined	High	High	High	Product Owner	Complete the Project Charter having all the business cases and ensure requirements are gathered properly	Escalate to project Board	Project Charter should be rewritten with full business case and requirements	Open	Project Charter Template
2	22 Dec 2021	Project design and deliverables/milestones are incomplete.	High	High	High	Product Owner	Define the scope and deliverables in detail OR take help from experts	Assumptions and constraints are defined in the document. Remove high-risk items.	Workshops for training on how to create deliverables and milestones scheduled	In Progress	Assumptions Log
3	23 Dec 2021	Non- Competent Resources	Medium	Medium	Medium	Project Manager	Schedule training or coaching from experts	Escalate to the project sponsor	The project sponsor agrees to hold a briefing and make arrangements for new resources	In Progress	Resource Planning Sheet
4	24 Dec 2021	Delays in appointing Expert Consultant or Freelancer	Low	Low	Low	Project Manager	Communicate schedule early and check-in with consultants and contractors regularly.	Escalate to the project sponsor	Lead time to be built on the project schedule for each delay in onboarding	Open	Lead time
5	26 Dec 2021	Unplanned work	High	High	High	Project Manager	Check all the plans and scope of the project. Document all assumptions and communicate clearly to the project manager.	Escalate to the project manager and develop a plan to mitigate cost and schedule	Project manager to attend a meeting with the project sponsor	Open	Project Schedule
6	27 Dec 2021	Lack of communication causes lots of issues	High	High	High	Project Manager	Create a proper communication plan and have it followed seamlessly	Correct misunderstandings immediately by clarifying all doubts. Take help from the project sponsor.	Communication plan in progress	In Progress	Communication plan

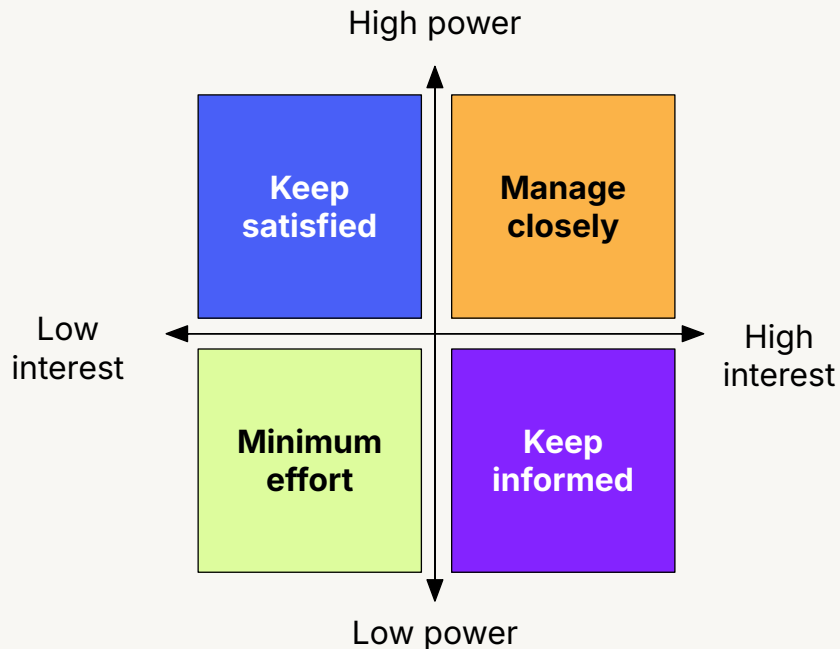


Stakeholder analysis

Step 1: Identify stakeholders: all individuals, teams, or external parties who are affected by or have influence over the project

Step 2: Categorise stakeholders using one of the following frameworks

Power-Interest Grid



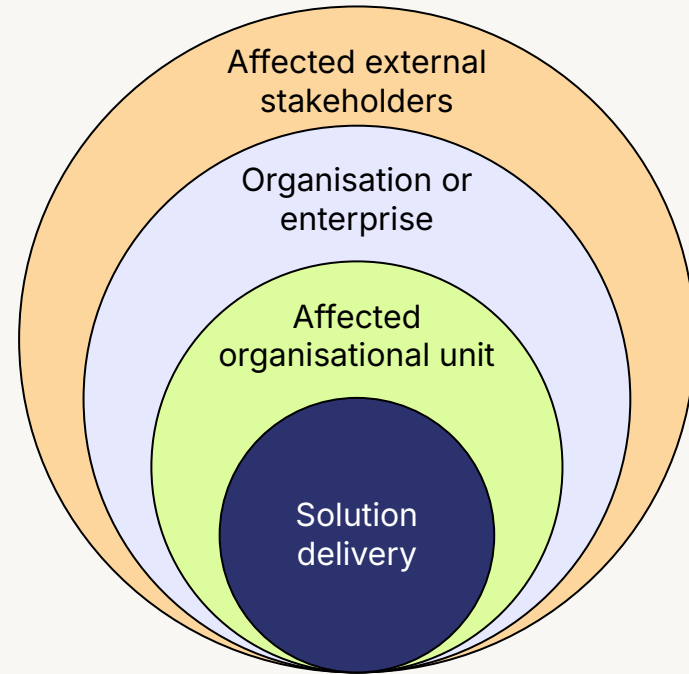


Stakeholder analysis

Step 1: Identify stakeholders — all individuals, teams, or external parties who are affected by or have influence over the project

Step 2: Categorise stakeholders using one of the following frameworks

Onion Diagram





Stakeholder analysis

Step 1: Identify stakeholders — all individuals, teams, or external parties who are affected by or have influence over the project

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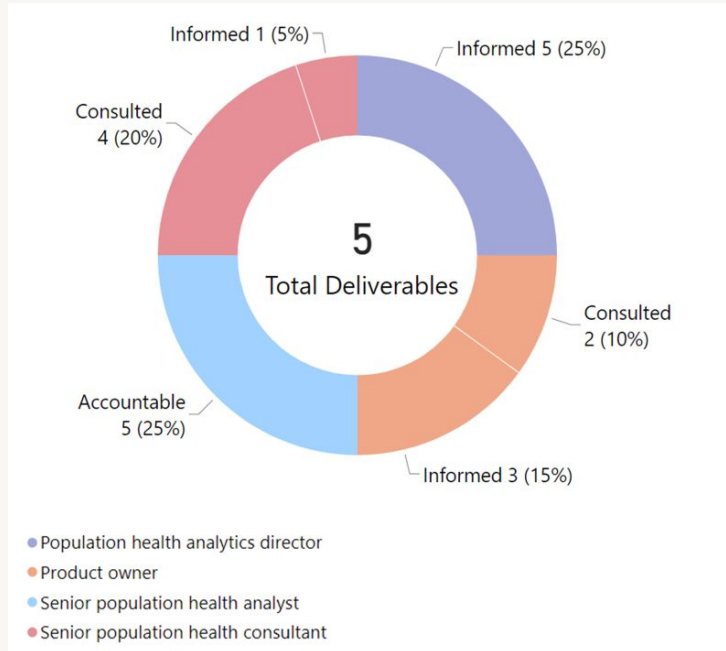
RACI Matrix

Project tasks	Senior Analyst	Project Manager	Head of Design	SVP Finance	SEO Lead	Sales Director	Senior Management
Phase 1: Research							
Economic model	R	I	I	A	C	I	I
Strategic framework	A	I	I	R	I	I	C
Risk factors	R	I	I	A	I	I	I
Phase 2: Structure							
Product specs	I	A	R	I	C	C	C
Design wireframe	I	C	R	I	C	I	C
User journey	I	C	R	I	C	C	C
User experience testing	I	C	R	I	C	C	C
Evaluation framework	I	R	C	I	C	I	C
Development backlog	I	R	C	I	C	I	C
Delivery roadmap	C	R	A	C	C	C	I

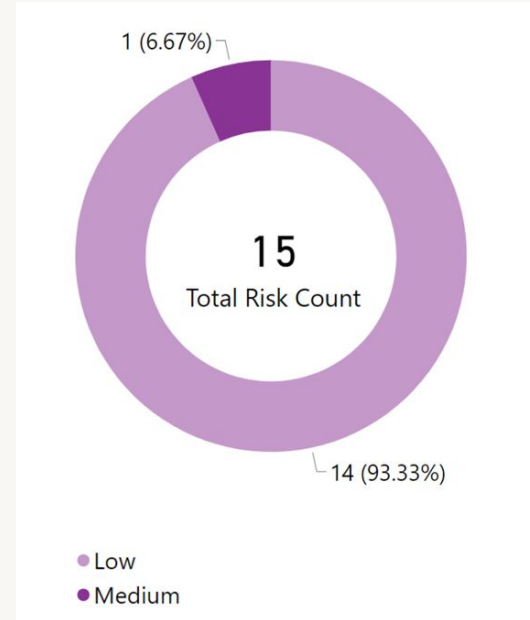


Other visualisation approaches

RACI matrix analysis chart



Risk probability rate chart





Phase 1: Define the Problem and Plan the Solution

Focus: Understanding the business context, analysing the problem, proposing solutions, scoping, and planning the delivery using project management methods.

12. Plan stakeholder engagement and communication

KSBs	K17, S13
Tips	• Build a communication plan (cadence, tools) • Use strategies like the Minto Pyramid, ELM, and Ethos/Pathos/Logos to tailor your messaging

13. Address legal, ethical, and data governance considerations

KSBs	B3
Tips	• Reference regulations like GDPR, Cybersecurity frameworks, or ISO27001 • Explain how personal data and system security are protected

Stakeholder communication plan

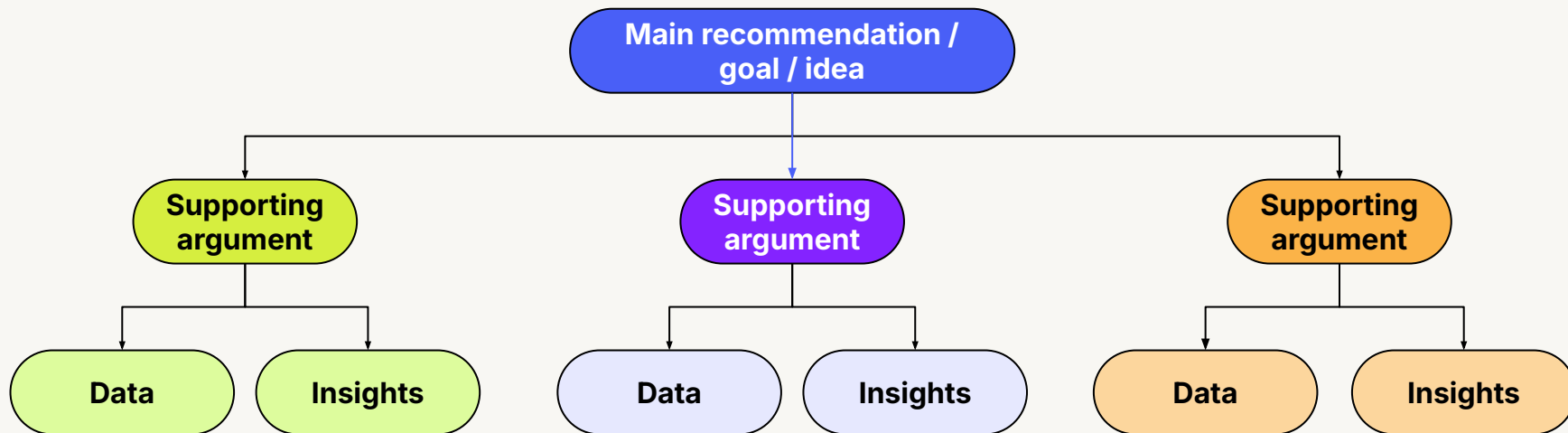
A **stakeholder communications plan** ensures no stakeholder is left behind and helps prevent misunderstandings, scope creep, or resistance to change

	Role	Interest	Power	Status	Message	Medium	Frequency	Who
John Smith	Project sponsor	High	High		Inform, consult	Bilateral Steering Committee	Biweekly	PM
Dennis Gordon	CFO	None	High		Involve	Bilateral Workgroup	Bi-weekly Ad hoc	PM



Communication frameworks

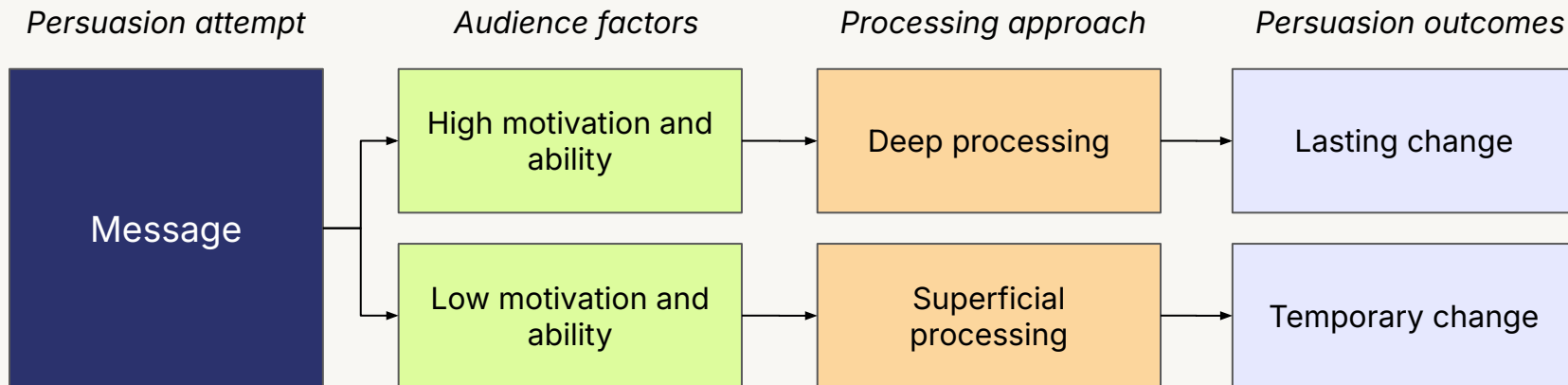
The **Minto Pyramid Principle** is all about structured thinking and communication.





Communication frameworks

The **Elaboration Likelihood Model (ELM)** explains how people process persuasive messages.





Communication frameworks

Ethos, Pathos, Logos outlines three ways to persuade your audience.

Ethos

Establishing
personal credentials

Getting your
audience to trust
you

Ethics

Pathos

Inspiring an
emotional response

Getting your
audience to feel

Pity

Logos

Arguing based on
reason and facts

Getting your
audience to think

Logic



Phase 2: Deliver the Solution

Focus: Working through each phase of the SDLC to design, build, test, deploy, and monitor the solution.

14. Planning and requirements analysis

KSBs	S16, S18
Tips	• Consider functional and non-functional requirements • Write user stories to document requirements • Prioritise needs using MoSCoW or gap analysis

15. Design the solution

KSBs	K27, S17, S26
Tips	• Create architecture diagrams or UML to capture the design • Justify design decisions based on requirements; highlight trade-offs in your approach



Phase 2: Deliver the Solution

Focus: Working through each phase of the SDLC to design, build, test, deploy, and monitor the solution.

16. Implement the solution

KSBs

K26, S19

Tips

- Explain the tools (languages, frameworks, dev tools) and methods (Agile, pairing) used and why you used them

17. Testing

KSBs

K25, K26

Tips

- Explain how testing improved the quality of your code
- Choose test frameworks (pytest, JUnit) and tools (Selenium, Cypress) appropriate to your solution



Phase 2: Deliver the Solution

Focus: Working through each phase of the SDLC to design, build, test, deploy, and monitor the solution.

18. Deploy the solution

KSBs

S26

Tips

- Make the decision to release the solution based on risks and benefits

19. Monitoring and maintenance

KSBs

K25, S22

Tips

- Plan retros and post-mortems to improve processes
- Identify key performance metrics to monitor

Phase 3: Reflect, Manage, and Conclude

Focus: Critical reflection, project management, communication, and final recommendations.

20. Write a critical summary and reflection

KSBs

S22

Tips

- Use a storytelling structure to explain your journey
- Reflect on challenges, outcomes, and what you'd do differently

21. Identify and resolve deviations from the plan

KSBs

S6

Tips

- Discuss where your plan changed and how you adapted
- Show continued use of PM methodology to resolve issues

Phase 3: Reflect, Manage, and Conclude

Focus: Critical reflection, project management, communication, and final recommendations.

22. Present final recommendations and conclusion

KSBs

S6, B5

Tips

- Make evidence-based recommendations
- Reiterate benefits and next steps
- Communicate with professionalism and impact



Q&A checkpoint





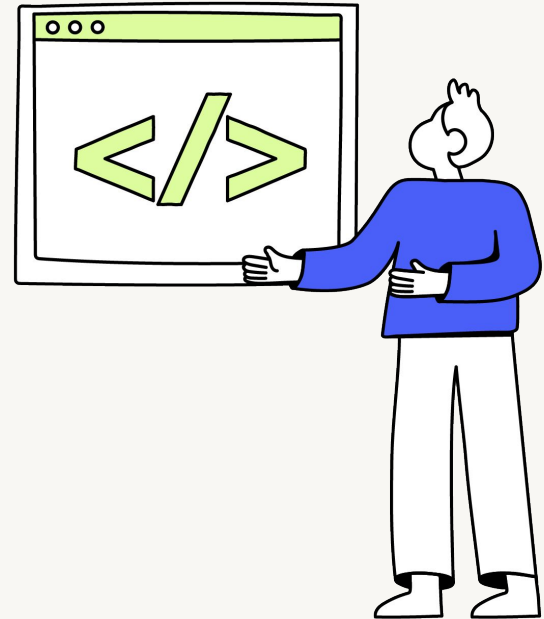
Oral presentation overview



AM1 component 2: Presentation with questioning

Purpose: Assess your ability to articulate your learning and project experiences, demonstrating the application of knowledge and skills evidenced in the Capstone Project

Structure: 30 minute presentation, 30 minute Q&A with assessor (up to 10% buffer)





Session structure

Project demonstration

Share your presentation screen to showcase relevant projects, highlighting practical applications of their learning

Capstone Project discussion

Detailed overview of the Capstone Project, including objectives, methodologies, outcomes, and reflections

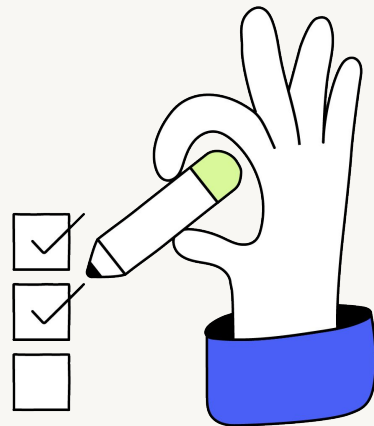
Q&A session

Interactive segment in which assessors ask at least 4 questions to probe deeper into your understanding and experience



Session housekeeping

- Presentation is scheduled up to 10 days after submission of the project report
- Have a valid form of ID (passport / driver's license only)
- Have your slides ready for presentation
- Speakers notes are allowed but must be submitted with the presentation, not added after
- Camera must be on at all times (no camera, no presentation)
- Assessor might ask you to show your environment
- Present in the meeting: Assessor, apprentice, and (maybe) mediator for quality control





Presentation tips

Focus on the why, not the what

Don't just explain what SWOT or RACI is. Explain why you used it and how you implemented it. Include organisational context.

The template is a guide, not a rule

Following the template too literally can make for a disjointed presentation. Use it as a guide.

Clear objectives are paramount

Without them, it can be hard to estimate resources and risks or fully evaluate the techniques used.

Be clear on references

References should explain why a piece of research was used and how it supported your work



Q&A checkpoint





Presentation skeleton



The presentation should cover...

- Introduction and current role
- Provenance of the project
- Problem context/analysis
- Problem statement
- Proposed solution
- Goal statement
- Scope
- Deliverables
- Methodology
- Timelines and charts
- Stakeholder mapping and engagement
- Communication
- Risk issues
- Budget/costs
- Implementation
- Outputs
- Outcomes
- Impact
- Evaluation of outcomes
- Recommendations
- Professional growth

Cover Slide

Agenda

- What the presentation will cover

Introduction

- Your company, your role, and your role as a project leader
- The situation in which you realised you had a problem to solve
- The importance to solve this problem for your organisation

Problem Statement

- Problem analysis tool: root cause analysis
- Problem statement

Proposed Solution and Goal Statement

- Discuss alternative
- Pitch your solution
- Clear goal statement

Scope

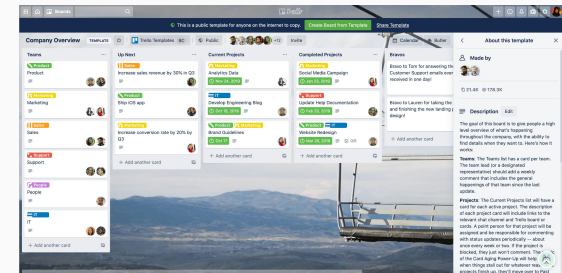
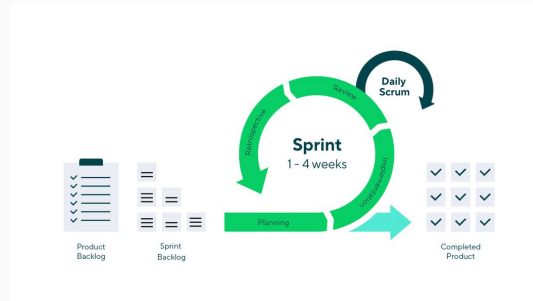
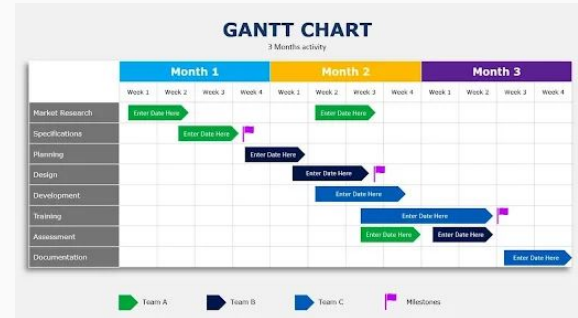
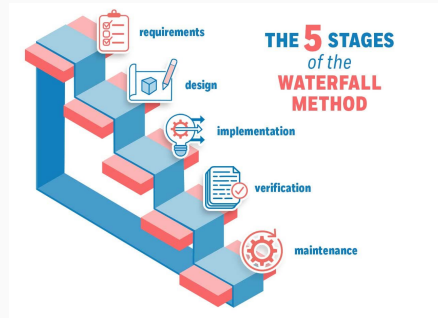
- Stakeholder requirements:
 - MoSCoW analysis (consider budget expertise and deadlines)
 - Iron triangle model
 - SWOT
- Analysis tools used
- Two statements: "in scope" and "out of scope"

Deliverables

- Discuss how you created your tasks and deliverables
 - For example, did you use SMART goal setting?

Methodology and Timelines

- Agile, waterfall, or hybrid
- Use visual aides

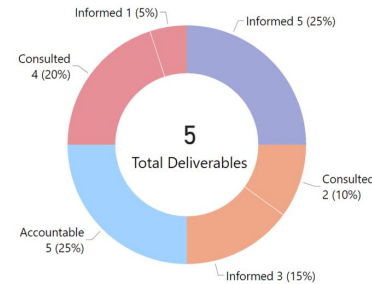


Stakeholders

- Stakeholder analysis
- Use visual aides

Project tasks	Senior Analyst	Project Manager	Head of Design	SVP Finance	SEO Lead	Sales Director	Senior Management
Phase 1: Research							
Economic model	R	I	I	A	C	I	I
Strategic framework	A	I	I	R	I	I	C
Risk factors	R	I	I	A	I	I	I
Phase 2: Structure							
Product specs	I	A	R	I	C	C	C
Design wireframe	I	C	R	I	C	I	C
User journey	I	C	R	I	C	C	C
User experience testing	I	C	R	I	C	C	C
Evaluation framework	I	R	C	I	C	I	C
Development backlog	I	R	C	I	C	I	C
Delivery roadmap	C	R	A	C	C	C	I

RACI Matrix Analysis Chart



● Population health analytics director
 ● Product owner
 ● Senior population health analyst
 ● Senior population health consultant

Risk Probability Rate Chart



● Low
 ● Medium

Communication

- Strategy: Minto, ELM, or Ethos
- Communication plan
- Use visual aides

	Role	Interest	Power	Status	Message	Medium	Frequency	Who
John Smith	Project sponsor	High	High		Inform, consult	Bilateral Steering Committee	Biweekly	PM
Dennis Gordon	CFO	None	High		Involve	Bilateral Workgroup	Bi-weekly Ad hoc	PM

Risk

- Full risk assessment
- Visualise it

Budget (Costs)

- Discuss all considerations, even if it is just your salary
- Don't forget costs associated with risks
- Visualise it

Project Implementation

- Adapt your speech to different audiences
- Use metaphors
- Keep it brief
- Include outputs

Outcomes

- Outcomes translated to information for business decisions

Impact Analysis

- Business impact analysis (BIA) or cost-benefit analysis (CBA)
- Business value
- ROI and impact story

Evaluation

- Did you solve the business problem?
- Compare outcomes to initial objectives

Recommendations

- Future work
- Roll out and next steps
- Improvements

Professional Growth

- Skills acquired during the apprenticeship
- Relevance of skills in Your Capstone Project
- Feedback received
- What's next? Personal development plan (PDP)

Conclusion

- Conclusive remarks
- Revisit the entire project and summarise it
 - Do not bring new ideas, arguments, or references

Thank you!

Appendix Slide

- Add references here



Q&A checkpoint





Independent work time



Independent work time

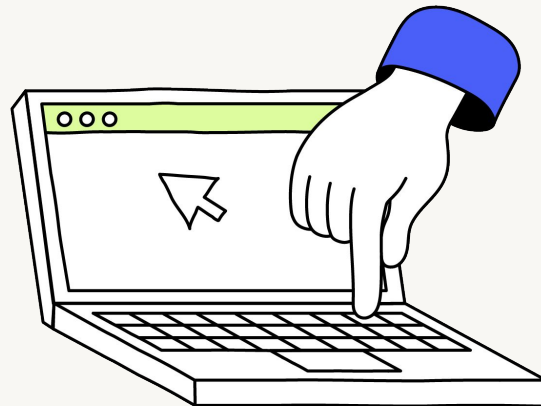
Open My Multiverse: ASWE Capstone Project (AM1) Readiness Tool module



Review the resources provided

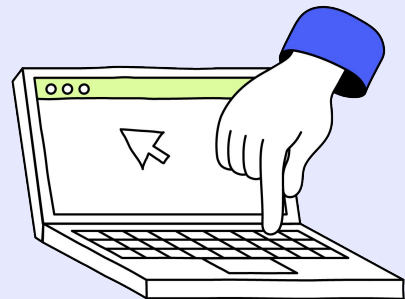


Continue working on your Capstone Project and proposal independently





On a scale of 1-5, how
prepared do you feel for
your Capstone Project?
What would help you feel
more prepared?





Next steps

- Continue working on your project proposal
- Log your OTJ

